



Advertiser-friendly apps

Apps from the Android Market pass on user data to ad networks
<http://bit.ly/wle5CN>

KLP to follow Jelly Bean

Key Lime Pie is expected to be released in 2013, if not earlier
<http://vrge.co/zbMIVS>

Best apps for the traveller

Vishal Mathur

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

If you're an avid traveller, you may not have realised the power of your smartphone to simplify all your journeys that you undertake now and in the future.

If you've already been using some apps to do this, we'd love to hear about your experience using them – write to us at editor@thinkdigit.com. But if you're yet to explore the idea, here are some apps to get you started and on the way to getting extra value for the money you spend on your upcoming trips, and also in a way unlocking your smartphone's hidden potential. Here we go:

Ask A Nomad

For any new place you visit, inevitably there are bound to be a lot of questions – mostly regarding which place to visit. Quite simply, Ask A Nomad lets you ask a question, and get answers from other users who may have some idea about that subject. This is a lot more interactive than just searching for information on the web. Alternatively, you can also answer questions about places you've been to. The app divides the world very neatly into continents, countries and then cities. This



Ask A Nomad utilizes crowd knowledge

makes asking a new question, reading other discussions and even replying to a query sim-

pler. Neat way of getting all the information you need about a place, from people who've probably already been there!

Price: Free

Platform: iOS devices

Agoda.com

This is an app you should definitely refer to, because it will surely have information on the hotel that you plan on staying in. Considering over 1,60,000 hotels worldwide are a part of this database, users can search for hotels based on pricing and type, and even get special deals. This service also lets you book using a credit card, along with special offers and deals from time to time.

We believe that even though you may find it a little risky to book from here, it's a useful app to check out and compare hotels. Also available as a full-fledged web site.

Price: Free

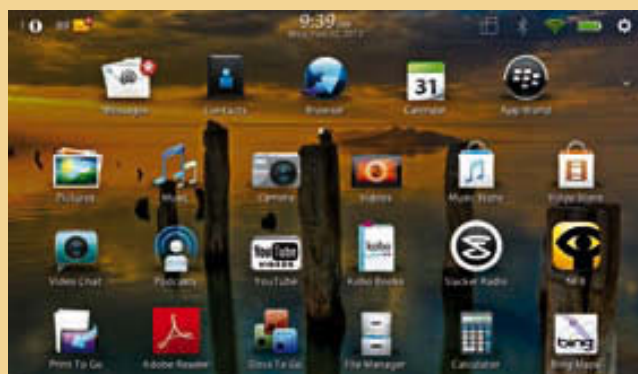
Platform: iOS devices

Oh Joy! PlayBook finally gets its update!

The last couple of months have been hectic, particularly as far as OS updates are concerned. Amidst all that, the BlackBerry PlayBook got its much-awaited update, bringing

in the native email, Android apps and a new version of the Bridge app. This immediately followed the limited time price reduction on the tablet in most markets globally. While it retains the previous OS's UI, there are

very slight tweaks to make it look better. Performance and multi-tasking remain as brilliant as before. You don't need to have a BlackBerry phone hooked up to it all the time for mail. Social networking has been better integrated as well. However, Android apps have been a bit of a disappointment – limited in number and most of them are in the paid avatar! We don't think this OS update will really change the fortunes of the tablet. RIM needs to go back to the drawing board and ensure that the next PlayBook is actually up to par with the competition and has a proper app ecosystem in place. **d**



The enhanced interface looks exactly like the older version

Foursquare

Okay, this app isn't very new, but it's a must-have on every smart mobile device. And most people have used it.

But if you have a number of contacts who're explorers in their own right, this may just be the app for you.

Utilise the knowledge base of your friends to get information about a place you're going to visit, or have already checked in to. Also get recommendations from other users who've visited the place and written reviews about it.

Price: Free

Platform: Android, BlackBerry, iOS, Symbian and Windows Phone. **d**